

Ride the Waves of Recovery

2027 RETREAT THEME

January 15-17, 2027 • Hilton Head Island, SC

BACK TO THE BASICS *and* HOW TO APPLY THEM

Call for Presenters, Panelists, & Workshop Leaders

The Ride the Waves Retreat Planning Committee is seeking speakers, panelists, and workshop leaders for our 2027 retreat, **Back to Basics and How to Apply Them**. We are looking for people who can share not only their experience with the 12 Steps, but how they have learned to put recovery into practice in everyday life—in relationships, difficult conversations, boundaries, sponsorship, service, emotional healing, and more. Whether through a personal story, an interactive workshop, or a panel discussion, we invite you to help others explore what it means to take the principles of recovery off the page and live them—one day at a time.

We've included our 2027 Theme & Program Framework to give you a clearer picture of the kinds of topics and practical recovery experiences we hope to offer. These are not intended to limit your creativity—we welcome your own ideas for speakers, panels, and workshops that fit within the overall spirit and focus of the retreat.

If you are interested in being a speaker, panelist, or workshop leader, we'd love to hear from you! Please send us a brief description of the topic you would like to address, how it connects with the 2027 retreat theme, and the type of presentation you have in mind (speaker, panel, or workshop). You don't need to have everything worked out—we're interested in hearing your ideas.

Please contact any member of the Speaker Committee:

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**SEND US YOUR IDEAS BY
October 31, 2026**

Please review the attached **2027 Theme & Program Framework** for more detail. We hope it will spark ideas and help potential presenters identify an area where your experience, strength, and hope can contribute to the retreat.

Attachment: 2027 Theme & Program Framework

Recovery Retreat 2027 – Sessions/Topics

	Theme of the session (Not Necessary the Title)	Focus
1	The Foundation: Powerlessness, Acceptance & Letting Go	Steps 1–3, letting go of control, and becoming accepting teachable, trusting, willing, and develop spiritual growth (Step 11 will define spirituality/religion more later).
2	Taking an Honest Moral Inventory	There are different ways to work Step 4 (CODA patterns/ACA Approach/4th Step Chart/others, recognizing the patterns.
3	Step 5	How to work this step. Sharing with another person. Seeing ourselves without blame or shame, projecting onto others. Being responsible for our own behaviors and self-awareness.
4	Becoming Willing to Change	Working Steps 6–7. Becoming willing & ready to let go of our past ideas (shortcomings, defects) ... becoming humble.
5	Healing Relationships Through Amends	Steps 8–9, preparing and making amends, what is and is not a good amends.
6	Living in the Maintenance Steps: Steps 10	Recognizing our part by working Step 10, daily inventory, prayer/meditation, service. How to work Step 10 (sharing different ways to work it.) Step 10 all point toward taking responsibility for our own thoughts, feelings, and actions rather than trying to blame and/or change others. It is about how I live life today-one day at a time. Turning triggers into teachers. Let it begin with me.
7	Living in the maintenance Steps: Step 11	How to work Step 11. This step isn't about doing it "right." Instead, it's about building a relationship with whatever we refer to as our Higher Power, or if we don't believe in one, connecting to life in a meaningful way. It's crucial to develop our own interpretation of a higher power, which in turn influences our own version of prayer and/or meditation.
8	Living in the maintenance Steps: Step 12	How to work Step 12. Carrying the message it means living in a way that reflects recovery and offers hope when someone's ready to hear it. We avoid preaching or fixing people. Carry the message is "give it away if we want to keep it." Service can look a lot of different ways, such as: • help start, or set up, and run in person or Zoom meetings • sponsoring newcomers, engaging in outreach calls • organizing workshops, seminars, speaker meetings • organizing recovery picnics or potlucks • organizing camping weekends with a focus on recovery • organizing group studies (such as 12-Step or book studies). When we do service our own recovery program grows. The other part of this Step is practicing these principles in everyday life. It's about applying what we've learned with our families, jobs, and friendships.

9	Applying Recovery with Difficult Conversations: Moving from Control to Compassion	Moving from fear/resentments/blame to compassion or love: How to use the Steps to learn a new way of communicating which is clear, clean, consistent, and honest. Topics covered: • Unpack your feelings “What do you think, need, feel?” • Use brainstorming for options • Consult AI for ideas—not as a substitute for human wisdom, experience, and accountability • Develop a plan, try it, revise when necessary • Review with wise recovery friend(s) • Speak with respect, including: ~ refrain from saying the “you” word ~ refrain from saying the “should” word ~ use eye contact ~ use listening skills, including body language ~ use feedback to understand ~ refrain from interrupting • Ask questions to understand • Replace advice with your experience • Respect another person's choices • Express feelings honestly • Avoid blame, judgment, and control • Invite rather than persuade • Encourage instead of correcting • Avoid rescuing/enabling/people pleasing
10	Applying Recovery: Healthy Boundaries	Define boundaries. How healthy boundaries relate to the Steps: their purpose, how to set boundaries, with detachment, including personal responsibility.
11	Applying Recovery: Recovery Back Home	Applying recovery with family, children, friends, spouses, partners, and jobs.
12	Getting a Sponsor	• Guiding sponsee through the 12 Steps. • Healthy sponsorship relationships. • Changing sponsors • Definition, qualification of sponsorship, types of: primary sponsor, temporary sponsor, co-sponsor, group sponsorship
13	Sponsor Training	• Guiding sponsee through the 12 Steps • Sharing how we did the Steps • Healthy sponsorship relationships (What it is and what isn't). • Changing sponsors. • explaining the tools of recovery • Types, definition, qualification of sponsorship: sponsor, temporary sponsor, co-sponsor, group sponsorship
14	Applying Recovery: Freedom from Fear, Shame, & Guilt	How this relates to the Steps. Applying recovery tools to emotional healing to become happy, joyous, & free.
15	Applying Recovery: Recovery in Meetings & Service	How this relates to the Steps. Traditions, group dynamics, servant leadership. And how to deal with difficult situations.
16	Applying Recovery: Living the Promises	How Steps and Traditions lead to the Promises CODA/ACA Promises The promises come true when we apply the steps & traditions.